

Kade Smiley

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Education

University of Washington, Seattle WA

B.S. Biology: Ecology, Evolution, and Conservation

B.S. Environmental Science and Resource Management

Research Experience

Undergraduate Researcher, Behavioral Ecophysics Lab

University of Washington (2025–present)

Advisors: Dr. Valentina Alaasam, Dr. Alejandro Rico-Guevara

- Project: *Effects of Urbanization on Hummingbird Coloration Through Diet*
- Conducting field capture, morphometric measurement, and feather sampling of Anna's Hummingbirds to evaluate how urbanization influences diet composition and feather coloration
- Working and communicating with volunteers to maintain field sites
- Applying stable isotope analysis to estimate trophic level and protein intake along an urbanization gradient

Senior Intern, Coastal Observation and Seabird Survey Team (COASST)

University of Washington (2024–2025)

- Trained incoming interns and managed communication with volunteers
- Communicated and interacted with the general public on behalf of COASST
- Conducted data entry and verification on beached birds, marine debris, and social science surveys.
- Worked on data management and cleaning project for future publications

Field and Laboratory Experience

- Conducted 2 field necropsies in coursework with NPS, based on GPS clusters
- Trapped and banded Common Ravens (*Corvus corax*) with rocket-nets
- Served as primary field trapper and handler of Rufous Hummingbirds (*Selasphorus rufus*) for research training and preliminary data collection for grant proposals
- Handled and processed ~70 hummingbirds

Presentations

- **Smiley K**, Lee N, Rico-Guevara A, Alaasam VJ "Impacts of urbanization on hummingbird diet & coloration." Poster presented at the American Ornithological Society Annual Meeting, 2026.

Grants & Awards

- American Ornithological Society Travel Award (\$800)

Technical Skills

Statistical & Programming:

- R (advanced: GLMMs, PCAs, model selection, and visualization)
- Python (intermediate)

GIS & Spatial Analysis:

- ArcGIS Pro and QGIS (advanced: raster/vector workflows, spatial statistics)

Data & Productivity:

- Microsoft Excel (advanced: model building and fitting)

Field Technology & Instrumentation

- Breadboarding, circuit assembly, data logging

- Autonomous Recording Units (ARUs): deployment planning, scheduling, and audio file management for species detection and analysis

Backcountry Experience:

- Overnight trips from 1-5 nights
- Mountaineering

Publications & Science Communication

- COASST: "What is a LIGU?" July 23rd, 2025. <https://coasst.org/news-views/blog/what-is-a-ligu/>
- Birdnote: "Don't Extinguish the Firecrown: Island Conservation and Its Challenges." *Field Notes*, May 11th, 2026. <https://www.birdnote.org/explore/field-notes/2026/05/dont-extinguish-firecrown-island-conservation-and-its-challenges>
- Birdnote: "Juan Fernandez Firecrown." *BirdNote Daily*, June 12th, 2026. <https://www.birdnote.org/podcasts/birdnote-daily/juan-fernandez-firecrown>

Certifications

- Certificate in Ageing Birds by Molt Limit from Powder-mill Avian Research Center

Additional Experience

Camp Manager, Pedalheads (April – August, 2024)

- Managed and trained 10+ staff members; ensured safety, scheduling, and communication
- Taught up to 20 kids at a time and oversaw the teaching of 80 kids in a day.
- Coordinated daily logistics and resolved challenges efficiently to ensure smooth operations and participant safety.

References

- Dr. John Marzluff: corvid@uw.edu
- Dr. Clint Robins: clint.robins4@gmail.com
- Dr. Alejandro Rico-Guevara: colibri@uw.edu
- Dr. Valentina Alaasam: valentina.alaasam@gmail.com